

Technical Reporting Study Notes

1. Overview of Technical Reporting

Definition: A structured form of communication used to convey factual, objective, and specialized technical information.

Explanation: It connects technical experts and non-technical stakeholders using clear, data-based communication.

2. Use of Library and Information Gathering

Definition: Systematic identification, retrieval, and evaluation of reliable information.

Explanation: Uses journals, textbooks, and trusted sources for accurate reports.

3. Administering Questionnaires

Definition: Designing and distributing questions to collect primary research data.

Explanation: Questions should be neutral and clear.

4. Reviewing the Gathered Information

Definition: Checking collected information for credibility, relevance, accuracy, and bias.

Explanation: Removes unreliable or outdated information.

5. Technical Exposition

Definition: Writing that explains technical concepts, systems, or processes.

Explanation: Focuses on clarity and understanding.

6. Topical Arrangement

Definition: Organizing information by topics or categories.

Explanation: Helps readers find related information easily.

7. Definition

Definition: A precise explanation of a technical term or concept.

Explanation: Removes confusion about specialized words.

8. Classification and Division

Definition: Classification groups similar items; division breaks a complex thing into parts.

Explanation: Helps organize complex information.

9. Cause and Effect Analysis

Definition: Study of relationships between causes and outcomes.

Explanation: Used for troubleshooting and finding reasons for failures.

10. Effective Exposition

Definition: Informational writing designed for maximum clarity.

Explanation: Uses simple language and logical structure.

11. Exemplification

Definition: Using examples to explain ideas.

Explanation: Makes abstract concepts easier to understand.

12. Technical Narration

Definition: Step-by-step explanation of a process or event.

Explanation: Shows sequence and timeline.

13. Description and Argumentation

Definition: Description explains properties; argumentation supports a position with evidence.

Explanation: Both use logical and factual information.

14. Persuasive Strategy

Definition: Using evidence and logic to convince decision makers.

Explanation: Based on facts, not emotions.

15. Organizing Information and Generating Solutions

Definition: Structuring data to solve technical problems.

Explanation: Organized information helps create solutions.

16. Brainstorming

Definition: Generating many possible ideas.

Explanation: Ideas are collected before evaluation.

17. Organizing Material

Definition: Sorting research notes and information before writing.

Explanation: Creates a clear report flow.

18. Construction of Formal Outline

Definition: Creating a structured plan of a report.

Explanation: Prevents missing important points.

19. Outlining Conventions

Definition: Standard rules for making outlines.

Explanation: Shows hierarchy of information.

20. Electronic Communication

Definition: Sharing information through digital methods.

Explanation: Requires professional formatting and security.

21. Generation Solutions

Definition: Developing practical steps to solve problems.

Explanation: Converts ideas into actions.

22. Polishing Style

Definition: Editing to improve language and readability.

Explanation: Makes writing professional.

23. Paragraphs

Definition: Groups of sentences about one main idea.

Explanation: Technical paragraphs need clear topic sentences.

24. Listening Sentence Structure

Definition: Writing sentences that are easy to process.

Explanation: Avoids complicated sentence structures.

25. Clarity

Definition: Making information easy to understand.

Explanation: Uses precise words and direct sentences.

26. Length and Order

Definition: Controlling size and arrangement of information.

Explanation: Improves readability.

27. Pomposity

Definition: Use of unnecessarily complex or proud language.

Explanation: Reduces clarity.

28. Empty Words

Definition: Words that add no useful meaning.

Explanation: Removing them makes writing efficient.

29. Pompous Vocabulary

Definition: Using complex words instead of simple ones.

Explanation: Simple language is preferred.

30. Document Design

Definition: Visual arrangement of document elements.

Explanation: Includes spacing, headings, and layout.

31. Document Structure

Definition: Overall organization of a report.

Explanation: Guides readers through information.

32. Preamble

Definition: Introductory statement giving background.

Explanation: Explains purpose and scope.

33. Summaries

Definition: Short overview of important findings.

Explanation: Helps readers quickly understand reports.

34. Abstracts

Definition: Brief summary of research including problem, method, results, and conclusion.

35. Table of Contents

Definition: List of sections and page numbers.

Explanation: Helps navigation.

36. Footnotes

Definition: Notes or references at the bottom of pages.

Explanation: Provides extra information.

37. Glossaries

Definition: List of technical terms and meanings.

Explanation: Helps readers understand jargon.

38. Crossreferencing

Definition: Directing readers to related sections.

Explanation: Connects information.

39. Plagiarism

Definition: Using another person's work without credit.

Explanation: It violates academic honesty.

40. Citation and Bibliography

Definition: Citation gives source credit; bibliography lists sources.

Explanation: Supports research credibility.

41. Index

Definition: Alphabetical list of topics with page numbers.

Explanation: Helps find information quickly.

42. Appendices

Definition: Extra supporting information at the end of reports.

Explanation: Keeps the main report clean.

43. Typesetting Systems

Definition: Tools for formatting documents.

Explanation: Used for professional layouts.

44. Creating the Professional Report

Definition: Final preparation of a complete report.

Explanation: Combines content, design, and formatting.

45. Elements, Mechanical Elements, and Graphical Elements

Definition: Text sections, formatting tools, and visuals in documents.

Explanation: Together create professional reports.

46. Reports (Core Formats)

Includes proposals, progress reports, leaflets, brochures, handbooks, magazine articles, research papers, feasibility reports, project reports, technical reports, manuals, documentation, and theses.

47. Electronic Documents

Definition: Digital documents stored and read electronically.

Explanation: May contain links and interactive features.

48. Linear versus Hierarchical Structure Documents

Definition: Linear documents follow a sequence; hierarchical documents allow flexible navigation.

Explanation: Digital documents often use hierarchical structures.